

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Pritzker signs aid-in-dying law

Governor hails 'freedom' found in bill that drew strong opposition

By **Jeremy Gorner**
and **Olivia Olander**
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Gov. JB Pritzker on Friday signed into law a measure that would allow doctors to help terminally ill people end their lives after the controversial bill barely cleared the

Senate during the fall legislative session, where one skeptic said it could bring "a culture of death" to Illinois. Illinois now joins at least 10 other states, among them California, Hawaii, Colorado, Oregon, as well as Washington, D.C., in allowing medical aid in dying. It was among a handful of bills

Pritzker signed on Friday. In a statement about the medical aid-in-dying law, the governor said he was moved by supporters' "dedication to standing up for freedom and choice at the end of life in the midst of personal heartbreak." "Today, Illinois honors their strength and cour-

age by enacting legislation that enables patients faced with debilitating terminal illnesses to make a decision, in consultation with a doctor, that helps them avoid unnecessary pain and suffering at the end of their lives," he said.

Turn to Dying, Page 4



Gov. JB Pritzker answers questions during an interview in Chicago on Wednesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"If I am facing an illness where I am going to die in pain, do you think you should tell me I don't have the option to alleviate that pain?" — State Sen. Linda Holmes, of Aurora



Families walk to Helge A. Haugan Elementary School in Chicago's Albany Park neighborhood on Tuesday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'NO SPACE FOR US'

Parents share tales of overcrowding at Albany Park elementary school, but CPS denies plea for expansion

By **Hope Moses** | Chicago Tribune

Desks, tables and play areas for children were packed tightly near the printing area. Boxes and bins of nameless items on shelves swallowed her in, she said.

What was once a library had been converted into a very tight multipurpose room including a makeshift office space for counselors, teachers and the school's dean. Students and parents also meet there for student counseling sessions or parent conferences, when necessary.

Gomez found the crowding so concerning that she wrote it down in her personal journal so she'd never forget, she said. "There's no space for us. ... There's no space for them to play," Gomez wrote in

Turn to School, Page 2

Trump approval drops to new low

Public sours on his grasp of economic, immigration issues

By **Linley Sanders**
and **Will Weissert**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump's approval on the economy and immigration have fallen substantially since March, according to a new AP-NORC poll, the latest indication that two signature issues that got him elected barely a year ago could be turning into liabilities as his party begins to gear up for the 2026 midterms.

Only 31% of U.S. adults now approve of how Trump is handling the economy, the poll from Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research finds. That is down from 40% in March and marks the lowest economic approval he's registered in an AP-NORC poll in his first or second term. The Republican president also has struggled to recover from public blowback on other issues, such as his management of the federal government, and has not seen an approval bump even after congressional Democrats effectively capitulated to end a record-long

Turn to Trump, Page 6

EPSTEIN PHOTOS: House Democrats released a selection of photos from the estate of Jeffrey Epstein on Friday, including some of President Donald Trump, former President Bill Clinton and the former Prince Andrew. **Nation & World**



Resident Alex Manning talks with movers in the five-story apartment complex in the 7500 block of South Shore Drive in Chicago on Thursday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

Tenants, some with few options, forced to leave raided building

By **Darcel Rockett**
Chicago Tribune

The gate around 7500 South Shore Drive sat open Thursday, the buzzer system needed to access the building unnecessary. The front door was open, plexiglass falling out of the metal frame, the only brace against the cold.

In Apartment 506, water stands on the wood

floorboards. Tenant Alex Manning said it stems from the faulty radiator.

Each panel on the floor is so warped that it's hard not to trip. There is a bowling-ball-size hole on the wall covered with crinkled and folded duct tape. It is connected to a unit that suffered fire damage in January. Though there is moisture throughout most of his apartment, Manning

uses a space heater and the gas stove to stay warm.

Officials have called the South Shore building that federal immigration agents raided in a controversial middle-of-the-night operation "deplorable." For Manning and the other dozens of residents still living in the troubled apartment complex, it is home.

Turn to Tenants, Page 4

DISPUTING ICE CLAIMS: Elgin police said they have no evidence that people threw "rocks and bottles" at ICE agents during an hourslong effort to take a man into custody last weekend or that the city's officers "refused to help protect law enforcement." **Chicagoland, Page 3**

TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 11 Low -2

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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